Japan Portfolio Brief — Friday, October 23, 2026

Covers the Tokyo/Seoul sessions of Thu Oct 22 and Fri Oct 23 plus the week in context (Oct 19–23). Positions treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning:*** *this run's live research was thin. Page fetches failed in the environment, so most findings come from search-result summaries, and almost no company-specific news dated Oct 22–23 could be found for individual names. "QUIET" below means "nothing found," not "confirmed quiet" — check TDnet/DART/KIND before acting on any single-name call. Market-level and macro facts are better sourced. Gap since the last brief: the previous run was Aug 16, so this is not a one-day lookback for the macro thread.*

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1. Top of the stack

Your JGB (JP1024661QB1, 0.50%, due Nov 1, 2026) redeems in about nine days — decide the reinvestment now. One yield table lists the issue as 0.50% maturing 2026-11-01 (Bondscovery), but that same page is internally inconsistent (it also shows a 2026-12-01 field) and I could not verify the issue against Ministry of Finance records. Nov 1 is a Sunday, so redemption proceeds most likely settle Monday Nov 2 (this is standard practice, not sourced — confirm with the custodian); Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3 for Culture Day. Reinvestment options have moved against holding cash: the 2-year JGB yields about 1.87%, the 5-year 2.22%, the 10-year 2.79% and the 30-year 3.84% (Trading Economics, 30y), with the BoJ policy rate at 1.25%. The 10-year hit 3.115% on Sep 25, a 30-year high, then slipped below 3% (CNBC, MUFG Research); the 10-year fell about 8bp Friday on haven demand (Nikkei Asia summary).

An AI-funding scare has taken the Nikkei down ~8% from Oct 14. The Nikkei 225 closed Oct 14 at 67,744; fell 4.9% on Oct 15 to 64,426 (third-largest point drop on record, sixth straight decline) on reported CoreWeave debt distress plus hot US inflation, with Advantest −13.9%, Tokyo Electron −7.3% and SoftBank −9.4% (Matsui/Kyodo, Kumamoto Nichinichi); rebounded Oct 16; then slid again — 64,075 on Oct 20 (Minkabu), 64,621 on Oct 21 (Minkabu) and **62,908 on Thursday Oct 22 (−2.65%)**, the lowest since July 30, on Meta's raised spending outlook, Lam Research's guidance and a ~6.7% drop in the US semiconductor index (Il Sole 24 Ore, Kabutan wrap). **Friday Oct 23: Nikkei 62,693 (−0.34%) after being down ~1,080 points in the morning; TOPIX 3,965.81 (−0.79%)** (BigGo, rallies.ai). The index is about 13% below its June 25 record of 72,366.

September core CPI hit the BoJ's 2% target and pulled a December hike into focus. Core CPI (ex fresh food) rose 2.1% y/y, the first reading above 2% since December; headline 2.1%; core-core 2.4% (CNBC, Investing.com). The BoJ (1.25% after a 7–2 September hike) is expected to hold at the **Oct 29–30 meeting, decision Fri Oct 30** (Nikkei Asia); swaps price under 5% for October and ~80% for a Dec 18 hike (SpindepTH). The yen strengthened to ~156.1/USD, its best since Sep 18, as risk-off flows hit (rallies.ai).

SoftBank (9984) is the book's highest-beta AI/OpenAI proxy and has been hammered twice this week: −9.4% on Oct 15 (above) and −5.6% on Oct 22 per AP (Il Sole). One summary put the stock near ¥4,020 and −7% on Oct 23, but conflicts with other dated accounts — treat as unverified. Earlier: −11% on Sep 14–15 after Altman said OpenAI would not IPO in 2026 (Parameter).

Bank of Korea held at 3.00% (7–0) on Oct 22 after back-to-back hikes in July and August, said it will set the timing and pace of further increases, and next meets Nov 26 (Seoul Economic Daily, intellinews). KOSPI closed Friday at 5,550.30 (+0.3%) after an intraday low of 5,306; KOSDAQ 751.69 (−1.62%); foreigners net sold ~₩1tn; the won was 1,324.6/USD (Ajupress). *Flag:* the same research found KOSPI levels of 6,000–8,000 in June–October, so the level has fallen sharply; verify against KRX.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ/Takaichi:** the cabinet keeps an expansionary stance despite yen weakness; Finance Minister Katayama said Oct 15 that Tokyo stands ready to act on the yen again and that Trump raised yen weakness directly with Takaichi (Bloomberg). Tokyo

and Washington jointly bought yen in July after USDJPY topped 160 (first joint action since 1998); MUFG sees a 156–160 range (SpindepTH). Ueda has flagged possible rewording of the "underlying inflation nearing 2%" language (InvestingLive).

- **Fed:** FOMC Oct 27–28 (decision Oct 28); range 3.75–4.00% after a September hike; ~80% hold, with a December hike priced (Forbes). US jobs report Nov 6.
- **Tariffs:** the US-Japan 15% framework stands, with the $550bn investment pledge now producing projects — two GlobalFoundries fabs in New York funded with up to $21bn from Japan (Japan Times); a CRS note (Sep 22) says further tariff actions are under consideration (CRS). I found no October change to the auto rate; a JETRO summary dated Aug 26 still lists 15% all-in (JETRO).
- **Korea structure:** the Commercial Act amendment (passed Feb 25) requires newly bought treasury shares to be cancelled within a year, with a longer grace period for existing holdings (Law Times); a Capital Markets Act decree effective Jun 30 forces all listed companies with treasury shares to disclose holdings and disposal plans (FSC). 24-hour won trading began Jul 6 (BigGo). Nothing new dated Oct 19–23.

Megacaps & tech

The tape matters more than the single-name news here. **Sony (6758)** has an ongoing ¥500bn buyback through May 2027 (August purchases ¥43.5bn — FilingReader); Q2 results are projected around Nov 3–5 (unconfirmed — Nov 3 is a holiday). **Keyence (6861)**: date conflict — Investing.com shows results today, Kabuyoho says **Oct 29** (it reported Oct 29 in both 2024 and 2025, so Oct 29 is likelier); Q1 was a beat (sales ¥346.6bn +32.8%, OP +44.7%, margin 54%) (Keyence), so expectations are high into a tape that is punishing AI-adjacent names. **Omron (6645)**: one calendar showed an Oct 22 Q2 print but I found no results and its Q2 normally lands in early November (Nov 7 last year) — treat the date as unresolved (Omron). **Canon (7751)** Q3 projected Oct 27 (MarketScreener). **NAVER (035420)**: a Kyobo preview (Oct 6) projects a Q3 OP miss (snippet only); the Dunamu share-swap's regulatory status is a verify item. Quiet/no news found: Daikin (Q1 record sales ¥1,426.8bn, OP +7.6% — Quartr; results ~early Nov), Seiko Epson, Kubota, SHIFT, Appier (next results likely mid-Nov), Oro, MegaChips, RS Technologies, Sanken, Optex.

Banks & financials

No verified Oct 22–23 company news. Sector read-through: the CPI print and December-hike pricing support megabank/regional NIM (MUFG, Resona, SMTG, Japan Post, Kyoto FG, Fidea, Shimizu, Kita-Nippon) while the AI sell-off and falling long yields are a countervailing drag on sentiment; real-estate and rail names (Mitsui Fudosan, TOC, Keisei) are the rate-hike losers. **MUFG (8306)** Q2 results are listed Nov 13 (Kabuyoho); **Kita-Nippon (8551)** Nov 12 (Kabuyoho) — its FY3/26 net profit was ¥4.4bn (+8.8%) with ¥6.6bn ordinary profit guided this year. **Fidea (8713)**: Q2 date not found; the Jan 2027 Shonai/Hokuto merger was not re-confirmed by this run. **Japan Post, SBI, Mitsui Fudosan, TOC, Kyoto FG, Resona, SMTG, Shimizu**: nothing found. **JR Central (9022)** Q2 is slated for "late October" (likely Oct 29–30) and **Keisei (9009)** about Oct 30–31, both unconfirmed (Kabuyoho, Keisei).

Industrials, autos, materials

No company-specific Oct 20–23 news found for any name. Dated catalysts (sourced from Kabuyoho/Minkabu-style aggregators, not company IR): Suzuki Nov 10; Honda and Subaru "early November" (no day); Sumitomo Metal Mining Nov 10; Nakayama Steel Nov 5; KH Neochem Q3 ~Nov 5; Valqua Nov 4; Fudo Tetra Nov 9; Shibaura Machine Nov 11; Tigers Polymer Nov 11; JAPEX Nov 12; Yakult Nov 13; Tokyotokeiba ~Nov 13; Universal Entertainment ~Nov 13. Status notes:

- **Honda** raised FY OP guidance to ¥650bn on Aug 5–6; **Subaru** is guiding recurring profit ¥180bn vs consensus ~¥216bn (stock ¥2,511 on Oct 5).
- **Sumitomo Metal Mining**: Q1 recurring profit ¥118bn (36% of ¥324bn FY guide); metals prices are the driver and I have no current copper/nickel read.
- **JAPEX**: the Fundare US tight-oil acquisition reportedly completed Oct 1 (EV figures conflict: ~$278m vs ~$320m — TipRanks); Q1 recurring profit −72%; stock ¥1,683 on Oct 8 at 6.6x forward P/E.

- **Universal Entertainment**: H1 recurring profit ¥3.13bn is already 142% of the full-year guide — an upward revision is plausible but unannounced.
- **Shochiku (9601)**: interim net profit reportedly fell 82% to ¥736m on impairments including Osaka Shochikuza (Gamebiz) — release date unconfirmed.
- **Hi-Lex (7279)**: Oct FY-end; 9-month net income far exceeds recurring profit, implying a large one-off I could not identify; full-year results likely mid-December.
- **KH Neochem**: H1 recurring profit ¥7.45bn vs ¥4.5bn guided; **Katakura**: FY guide raised to ¥7.2bn; **Tokyotokeiba**: H1 ahead of consensus; **Obara** (Sep FY): FY results due in November, date unconfirmed.
- Nothing found: Ebara Jitsugyo, Tigers Polymer, Mitsubishi Materials, Fudo Tetra, Shibaura, Valqua, Nakayama, Yakult.

Korea names

Taekwang Industrial (003240) — the live governance fight: second-largest holder Trustone is in open conflict with management; in mid-September Taekwang filed a police complaint against Trustone's CEO (Bizwatch), and the value-up plan earmarks its 24.4% treasury stake for M&A pending 2027 AGM approval (Bizwatch). The new treasury-share rules may force a cancellation decision. No PRS item found. **Samsung C&T (028260)**: Yuanta expects Q3 OP of ₩966bn (−2.8% y/y, in line with ₩975bn consensus — Oct 19 preview); the report date conflicts (Oct 22 vs Oct 27) and no actual figures were found. **LG Electronics pref (066575)**: Q3 preliminary OP ₩781.8bn missed ~₩1.03tn consensus (Ajunews); full call due late October. **LG Chem pref (051915)**: Q3 consensus slashed to ~₩9.9bn OP with petrochemical price-fixing suspicions (Dealsite). **SK Inc (034730)**: SK hynix's ₩40tn buyback (Aug 20–Nov 19) is being cancelled; SK Square slid from ~₩1.19m (Oct 6) to ~₩755k intraday on Oct 23 (JoongAng) — SK hynix itself rose ~4.4% Friday after dropping the Solidigm US IPO. **SK Discovery (006120)**: ₩70,100 → ₩62,700 over Oct 8–15; portfolio restructuring "complete" per DB Securities. **LG Corp (003550)**: all treasury stock cancelled in May. **Daewon Sanup (005710)**: management-control lawsuits filed in July — check KIND. Quiet/no news: Amorepacific (Q3 likely early Nov), F&F, Hyosung, ILJIN, LS Corp, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Eusu, Ubiquoss.

3. Probably noise

- **Unattributed "SoftBank −7% on Oct 23" figures** — conflicts with dated accounts; the confirmed moves are Oct 15 and Oct 22.
- **Aggregator earnings dates** (Investing.com showing Keyence today, Omron Oct 22) — conflict with company history; verify on IR pages before treating as events.
- **Hi-Lex's 9-month net income spike** — a one-off; recurring profit guidance is unchanged.
- **Shochiku's interim net-profit drop** — impairment-driven, not operating.
- **Korean wire items from one-off dividend sites** (Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang) — unverified and low-signal.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB JP1024661QB1 (0.50%, due Nov 1, 2026) — decision needed. Redemption at par is expected on/around Mon Nov 2; confirm the issue and settlement date with the custodian/MOF (I could not). Reinvestment candidates: 2y ~1.87%, 5y ~2.22%, 10y ~2.79% — all well above the 0.50% coupon but sensitive to the Oct 30 BoJ outcome (hold expected) and December-hike pricing. `watchlist-japan.md` flags this as maturing-soon; it should be removed after redemption is confirmed.

Calendar (through ~Nov 13; dates marked * unconfirmed):

- Oct 27: Canon Q3*
- Oct 28: FOMC decision
- Oct 29: Keyence H1* (conflicting sources)
- Oct 29–30: BoJ meeting, **decision Oct 30** (~12:00 JST) with outlook report; JR Central Q2 late Oct*; Keisei ~Oct 30–31*

- Nov 2: JGB redemption/settlement (expected)
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed (Culture Day)
- Nov 3–5: Sony Q2*; Nov 4 Valqua*; Nov 5 Nakayama Steel*, KH Neochem Q3*
- Nov 6: US October jobs
- Nov 9–13: Fudo Tetra Nov 9*; SMM and Suzuki Nov 10; Shibaura and Tigers Polymer Nov 11*; JAPEX and Kita-Nippon Nov 12*; MUFG, Yakult Nov 13*
- Nov 26: BoK

Undated-but-live: SoftBank's OpenAI financing needs and any margin-loan news; Taekwang/Trustone treasury-share and police-complaint developments; Universal Entertainment guidance revision; LG Electronics earnings call (late Oct); intervention risk if USDJPY rebounds toward 160; Sanken/Allegro stake overhang.

Identity/watchlist flags: (1) **8551 vs 8524 — still open for owner:** 8551 is The Kita-Nippon Bank (small, Iwate); "North Pacific Bank" is 8524 (Q1 ordinary profit ¥11.2bn, 25% of the ¥44.4bn full-year forecast — Daiwa IR). Coverage continues on 8551. (2) The governor of the Bank of Korea could not be reliably identified — names in coverage conflict. (3) No instrument matured or was unidentifiable this run except the JGB above, whose issue-level details remain unverified.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** what is the exact MOF issue, redemption date and settlement date, and what is the intended reinvestment (roll into 2s/5s vs. wait until after Oct 30)?
- **SoftBank (9984):** what did the stock actually do on Oct 23, and where do the $10bn OpenAI-backed margin loan and the Oct 1 OpenAI tranche stand?
- **Keyence (6861) / Omron (6645):** confirm results dates; if Keyence prints Oct 29, how much of the Q1 beat is priced after the AI-tape sell-off?
- **Banks:** what are the Q2 dates for Resona, SMTG, Kyoto FG, Japan Post and SBI, and how much of the December-hike pricing is in the stocks?
- **Fidea (8713) / Kita-Nippon (8551):** reconfirm the Fidea Bank merger timetable; resolve with the owner which bank is actually held.
- **Samsung C&T (028260):** did Q3 print Oct 22 or does it print Oct 27, and what is the Samsung Electronics/Biologics read-through?
- **Taekwang (003240):** any DART filing on treasury-share cancellation or the PRS under the new disclosure decree?
- **SK Square/SK Inc (034730):** why did SK Square fall from ~₩1.19m to ~₩755k since Oct 6?
- **Hi-Lex (7279):** what was the one-off driving 9-month net income?
- **KOSPI:** what drove the move from ~7,000 (Aug) to ~5,550, and is foreign selling continuing?